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PANEL 01/14 · MASTER QUESTION AND EVIDENCE RULE	
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How can text-free deep time become evidence-based history?	
LITHICS + STRATIGRAPHY + DATES + FAUNA/FLORA + BODIES + ART + LANDSCAPE	
OBSERVE -> ASSOCIATE -> DATE -> INTERPRET -> QUALIFY	
Verdict: material abundance permits history, but confidence varies by context.	
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PANEL 02/14 · CHRONOLOGY WITHOUT A PAN-INDIAN LADDER	
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Lower Palaeolithic -> Middle Palaeolithic -> Upper Palaeolithic -> Mesolithic	
bifaces/core-flake -> prepared flakes -> blades/burins -> microlithic composites	
MACRO PHASE -> REGIONAL SEQUENCE -> DATED STRATUM -> ASSEMBLAGE	
Transitions overlap; phase labels are neither races nor universal dates.	
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PANEL 03/14 · PLEISTOCENE-HOLOCENE AND DATING	
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Climate/river/sea-level change -> resources shift -> human choices change	
Stratigraphy = relative order radiocarbon = suitable organics	
Luminescence = mineral exposure event typology = comparison, not sole date	
A date belongs first to the sampled event; redeposition and error matter.	
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PANEL 04/14 · LITHIC OPERATIONAL CHAIN	
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RAW STONE -> CORE -> FLAKE/BLADE -> RETOUCH/BACKING -> HAFT/USE -> DISCARD	
Read cortex, hammerstones, rough-outs, debitage, wear, residues and spacing.	
Primary context preserves activity relation; secondary context is displaced.	
Tool form suggests function; assemblage and use evidence test it.	
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PANEL 05/14 · LOWER PALAEOLITHIC AND ACHEULIAN	
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Acheulian = assemblage marked by bifacial handaxes and cleavers.	
Also retain choppers, flakes, cores, hammerstones and resharpening debris.	
Soanian/Madrasian cannot be treated as sealed races or civilisations.	
Technology records learned choices, not one hominin species.	
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PANEL 06/14 · REGIONAL LOWER PALAEOLITHIC LANDSCAPES	
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Soan-Siwalik: terrace lithics + fluvial caution	
Attirampakkam: deep Acheulian -> early regional Middle Palaeolithic transition	
Hunsgi-Baichbal/Isampur: water + quarry + manufacture + habitation	
Bhimbetka/Narmada/Son/Belan: recurrent corridors with different contexts.	
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PANEL 07/14 · NARMADA HOMININ CONTROL	
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1982 Arun Sonakia -> Hathnora cranial fragment in Narmada gravel context	
Associated fauna and nearby late Acheulian tools; later central-valley finds	
Competing labels: advanced Homo erectus / archaic Homo sapiens / intermediate	
Safe claim: rare archaic hominin evidence; age, taxon and authorship debated.	
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PANEL 08/14 · MIDDLE PALAEOLITHIC	
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Flakes + scrapers + points + borers; older bifaces may continue.	
LEVALLOIS: shape convexities -> prepare platform -> detach planned flake	
Attirampakkam, Nevasa, Didwana and Son-Belan show regional sequences.	
Levallois is a method, not a finished tool or biological population.	
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PANEL 09/14 · UPPER PALAEOLITHIC	
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Parallel-sided blades + burins + some bone tools	
Kurnool caves: organic tools/fauna Patne/Bhimbetka: eggshell ornaments	
Ochre, beads and special objects widen evidence for communication.	
Symbolism is supportable; exact ritual, deity or social code is not.	
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PANEL 10/14 · LIFEWAYS AND INFERENCE LIMITS	
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Plants + game + fish + turtles + shellfish -> broad flexible subsistence	
Quarry -> task camp -> recurrent camp -> shelter = linked settlement system	
Fire/hearth claims require anthropogenic burning in secure context.	
Sharing and learning are plausible; rank and gender need independent evidence.	
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PANEL 11/14 · MESOLITHIC TECHNOLOGY AND RESIDENCE	
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Fine stone -> bladelet -> backed/geometric microlith -> composite implement	
Broad-spectrum niches -> processing/storage -> varied residence	
Microliths can pre-date the Holocene and continue with food production.	
Semi-sedentism needs a bundle: deposits, huts, hearths, seasonality, burials.	
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PANEL 12/14 · MESOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP	
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Bagor: long sequence + disputed domesticates Langhnaj: burials/wild fauna	
Adamgarh: long sequence; date/stratigraphy caution Bhimbetka: layered art	
Sarai Nahar Rai/Mahadaha/Damdama: wetlands + burials + longer residence	
Chopani Mando: huts/grinding/wild rice Baghor II: microlith manufacture.	
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PANEL 13/14 · BURIALS, ROCK ART AND TRANSITION	
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Burial -> treatment/memory; belief, kinship and hierarchy need patterns.	
Bhimbetka superimposition -> relative order; paintings span several periods.	
Grinding/pottery/wild rice -> processing/use, not automatic cultivation.	
Foraging, management, herding and cultivation overlapped regionally.	
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PANEL 14/14 · UPSC EXECUTION AND QUALIFIED VERDICT	
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PRELIMS: period + region + technology + certainty; eliminate category errors.	
2019 Denisovan: archaic human population; no Indian fossil claim follows.	
MAINS: claim -> named site/assemblage -> analysis -> qualification -> comparison.	
VERDICT: Indian prehistory is a regional mosaic, not a teleological ladder.	
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